

753 BCE

FOUNDING OF ROME

The enduring foundation myth of the city of Rome tells the story of the twin sons of the god Mars, Romulus and Remus. Left to die on the banks of the Tiber as babies, they were rescued and suckled by a she-wolf. They returned to the site as adults, intent on building a city there. A dispute over where to locate the city led to the death of Remus, after which Romulus founded Rome on the Palatine Hill in 753 BCE and reigned as its first king.

“Rome has grown since its humble beginnings that it is now overwhelmed by its own greatness”

LIVY, HISTORY OF ROME, 10 BCE



◀ Romulus and Remus suckled by a she-wolf

745–727 BCE The Assyrian Empire expands across Mesopotamia, out to the Mediterranean, and from Scythia in the north to the Arabian peninsula

701 BCE

c. 750 BCE King Piye of Kush invades Egypt and establishes a Nubian 25th Dynasty

c. 750 BCE The epic poems of Homer are written down for the first time, using a Phoenician-style alphabet



**8th century BCE
HOMER**

Author of the *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey*, Homer is a legendary figure. As part of an oral tradition, it is possible that poems ascribed to him are in fact the work of several authors over a long period.

▽ Pyramids of Meroë Sudan, Africa



c. 720 BCE

CONSTRUCTION OF THE PYRAMIDS AT MEROE

In the 8th century, the capital of the Kingdom of Kush was at Napata, but several members of the royal family originated from further south, in the city of Meroë. This became the chosen burial site for this side of the family, and a tomb complex was built there in 720 BCE. The pyramids containing the tombs were in the Nubian style, with steep sides.